
JOB APPLICATION SUBMISSION

Loop — Discovery Grid Prototype

Challenge 02 · Local discovery product · Coded Next.js prototype (Final Design + Interactive Prototype)

CANDIDATE

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Role of this submission

Product Design · Challenge 02

PROJECT LINKS

Live prototype: <https://loop-e6m3.onrender.com>

GitHub repository: <https://github.com/Sukhxdx/loop>

Note: The Render free tier may cold-start for a few seconds after idle.

WHAT THIS DELIVERABLE COVERS

01 Final Design — Discovery screen (default + filtered), card system, and detail states are implemented as a live UI (screenshot-ready from the prototype).

03 Prototype — Interactive Next.js app: filter → select → detail → close, plus cursor spotlight. Deployed at the live link above.

02 Design Thinking — Summary of problem framing and key decisions below.

04 Exploration — Weight-driven bento rhythm, loading skeletons, and empty states ship in the same build as layout studies.

CONCEPT

Loop is a local discovery app for Pune. Content types are Places, Bites (food), People, Happenings (activities), and Circles (groups). Cards are grounded in real neighborhoods and venues (Koregaon Park, Baner, FC Road, Bedekar, Shabree, Cafe Durga, Blue Tokai, and more) so the product reads as real — not lorem ipsum.

PROBLEM INTERPRETATION

The brief is less “how do I lay out cards” and more: how can discovery *feel* like discovery instead of search? Five unlike content types must coexist without collapsing into sameness or fracturing into five visual systems.

APPROACH

Built as a coded Next.js 14 prototype (App Router, TypeScript, Tailwind, Framer Motion) instead of static Figma frames — because the brief asks about behavior (hover, filter reflow, selection, exploration). Brand tokens are dark base + lime accent; originality went into typography hierarchy, bento rhythm, and one protected signature interaction.

KEY DECISIONS

- **Weighted bento grid** — card spans (1×1 to 2×2) come from a weight field, so hierarchy is intentional, not accidental masonry.
- **Mono data tag as unifier** — every card pins the same corner tag (0.6 KM, ■450, 12 MUTUAL, SAT · 8PM, 128 MEMBERS) so five types read as one family.
- **Person & Circle break silhouette** — circular avatar / fanned member stacks vs image-forward Place/Bite/Happening cards; difference is visible at a glance.
- **Cursor spotlight signature** — soft accent light trails the pointer and brightens nearby cards; everything else stays quiet so this reads as exploration, not chrome.
- **Real Pune substance** — addresses, hours, and menu highlights for real venues (Bedekar misal, Cafe Durga, Shabree thali, Arthur's Theme European menu, etc.).

TRADE-OFFS

Removed 3D card tilt after building it — tilt + hover lift + spotlight glow competed; protecting the spotlight as the single bold moment mattered more.

Coded prototype vs Figma — higher interaction fidelity (spotlight, shared-element detail, layout-animated filters); slower to iterate than frames.

Category chips over deep search — the brief asks for something that doesn't feel like search, so browse/filter leads.

HOW TO REVIEW

1. Open the live link → wait through the short skeleton load.
2. Try filter chips (Places / Bites / ...) and watch the grid reflow.
3. Move the cursor across the grid to see the spotlight find cards.
4. Open a Place or Bite for real address, hours, and menu highlights; use the primary CTA.
5. Optionally clone the GitHub repo and run `npm install && npm run dev`.

Thank you for reviewing this submission. I'm happy to walk through decisions live or extend the prototype.

— Sukhada Dhingra

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